

Roommate Dashboard

Software Review

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Prepared By: Group 6

1. Overview

This document serves as the Phase 1 Software Review for the Roommate Dashboard project. It describes how Group 6 identified stakeholder needs, gathered requirements, and developed a vision that directly addresses those needs. It also reflects on how our final feature set satisfies the goals expressed by our stakeholders.

2. Stakeholder Identification

The primary stakeholders for the Roommate Dashboard application are **college students and young adults living in shared housing**. These individuals face recurring challenges managing shared financial and household responsibilities with their roommates.

Identified Stakeholders:

- **Roommates (Primary Users)** — individuals sharing a living space who need to split costs and divide responsibilities.
- **Household Organizer** — a designated roommate who manages invitations, chore assignments, and household settings.
- **System Administrator** — responsible for overseeing system integrity and data accuracy.

3. How We Ascertained Customer Needs

Group 6 conducted **interviews with potential users** — specifically college students currently living with roommates — to understand their pain points and desired features. The interviews revealed consistent themes across participants:

- Difficulty tracking who owes what for shared bills (rent, utilities, groceries)
- Conflict arising from uneven chore distribution
- No centralized place to manage a shared grocery list
- Lack of transparency when bills or chores go unacknowledged

- Need for a simple, low-friction tool that all roommates would actually use

These interviews directly informed the requirements elicitation process and shaped the feature set defined in the Feature Set document.

4. How We Responded to Stakeholder Requirements

Each stakeholder need identified in interviews was translated into formal requirements and mapped to specific features:

Stakeholder Need	Requirement	Feature
Track shared bills	IR-004, ER-001, ER-002, ER-003	Bill Management Module
Know who owes what	ER-005	Balance Summary Dashboard
Mark bills as paid	ER-004, IR-004	Payment Tracking
Assign and track chores	IR-006, ER-006, ER-007	Chore Assignment System
Rotate chores fairly	ER-008	Chore Rotation Feature
Shared grocery list	IR-007, ER-009, ER-010	Grocery List Module
Transparency / dispute resolution	ER-011, NFR-009	Activity & Audit Log
Secure access	NFR-001, NFR-002, NFR-003	Authentication & Access Control
Works on mobile & desktop	NFR-008	Responsive UI Design

5. How Our Final Vision Satisfies Stakeholder Requirements

Our final vision for the Roommate Dashboard directly addresses every core pain point uncovered in stakeholder interviews. The application provides a single, unified platform that eliminates the need for spreadsheets, group chats, and verbal agreements — all common sources of confusion in shared housing.

The **Bill Management** module allows roommates to add, split, and settle shared expenses transparently, directly addressing the most frequently cited frustration of unclear financial obligations.

The **Chore System** with rotation support ensures responsibilities are distributed fairly and consistently, removing the social friction of manual chore negotiation.

The **Grocery List** gives all roommates a shared, real-time view of household needs, reducing duplicate purchases and missed items.

The **Activity Log** and **Audit Trail** provide the transparency stakeholders requested — ensuring that all changes are visible and accountable, which reduces the potential for household disputes.

Collectively, the 29 requirements documented across Inception, Elicitation, and Non-Functional categories represent a complete and traceable response to the needs expressed by our stakeholders. The Roommate Dashboard vision is feasible, valuable, and directly grounded in real user needs.